Chika Jinanwa

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EDUCATION

Minerva University- 3.92 GPA San Francisco, CA

Bachelor of Science, Double Major in Computer Science and Natural Sciences

Honors: Gold Medalist National Biology and Physics Olympiads, Minerva '23 Olympiad Scholar

Citations for Excellence: 2015 Best Science Student in Nigeria- National Mathematical Center, Abuja, Top 1.3% of chess players on Lichess.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, Ruby, Java, Scala, Golang, C#.

Libraries & Frameworks: Django, Node.js, React, Express, Bootstrap 4.

Databases & Tools: Kubernetes, SQL databases (PostgreSQL, MySQL), MongoDB, Git, Visual Studio, AWS, GCP, BigQuery, Azure.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Microsoft - Redmond, Washington 09/2024 - Present

Software Engineer- Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE)

- Designed and built a distributed, low-latency shadow validation service processing billions of endpoint calls daily, enabling real-time correctness checks of new service versions and seamless scalability—significantly improving test fidelity, deployment confidence, and the reliability of Microsoft Defender antivirus security, trusted globally.
- Engineered and migrated 3 critical MDE services to run seamlessly on Microsoft's proprietary ARM64-based silicon, improving CPU performance, memory efficiency, reducing infrastructure costs by 30%, and future-proofing the platform for next-generation planet-scale silicon-agnostic workloads.
- Designed and implemented an automated modernization and upgrade tool that orchestrated dependency updates, runtime upgrades, and service migrations across MDE's North American and Israel teams—reducing upgrade cycles from 2 weeks to under 3 hours, accelerating release velocity, minimizing manual error, and enabling engineers to focus on higher-value security features.
- Championed the adoption of automation tools and quality engineering practices to drive operational excellence across Microsoft Defender services, reducing manual effort, accelerating delivery, and improving reliability. Mentored engineers to deepen their understanding of modernization and migration strategies, clearly articulating technical goals and business impact to align teams and ensure successful cross-geo execution

Galileo Financial Technologies - Bay Area, California 07/2023 - 8/2024

Software Engineer II- Issuer Payment Processing Authorization Backend

- Led the design and integration of a Hardware Security Module (HSM) interface into a high-volume authorization system processing Mastercard transactions, strengthening encryption, and ensuring secure validation of sensitive 3D Secure data at scale.
- Designed and implemented a verification algorithm to automatically detect and resolve corrupted cardholder balances caused by database race conditions across multiple systems—ensuring financial accuracy, preserving customer trust, and improving system resilience under high concurrency.
- Conducted in-depth analysis of potential Distributed Denial of Service (DDoS) threats on the authorization system with a focus on database race conditions, and implemented guardrail code to reduce the impact of such attacks—proactively shaping mitigation strategies, hardening system resilience, and ensuring continuity of critical payment operations

Cruise - San Francisco, California 09/2022 - 12/2022

Software Engineer Intern - Developer Productivity Backend

- Independently built and deployed a GPU recommendations service to optimize developer workloads and cut infrastructure costs by ~$90K annually.

Google - Sunnyvale, California 05/2022 - 08/2022

Software Engineer Intern - Google Voice Android

- Built and launched VoIP and security-focused features for 5M+ Google Voice Android users, optimizing code to prevent data leaks and crashes, and collaborating cross-functionally to deliver secure, reliable user experiences